

## Week 3 of Conversations - May 25, 2025

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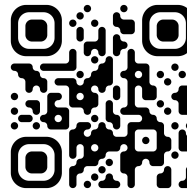
### I. Welcome!

If you are a first-time guest or you are wanting to plug in more to weekly virtual prayer meetings, our Wednesday night small groups, serving, or membership—*Fill out our digital connect card to stay connected!*



### II. Announcements

- Pentecost Sunday will be on June 8 at 6 pm with 10 Days of prayer leading up to it (May 28-June 6). Devotional guides are available to grab today! Register for Pentecost ATL by scanning this QR Code:**



### III. Message: Private Prayer: A Life of Conversation with God

*"Prayer is not monologue, but dialogue. God's voice in response to mine is its most essential part."*

— Andrew Murray

#### I. BIBLICAL EXAMPLES OF PRIVATE PRAYER

##### 1. Abraham – Prayer as Friendship

- *Genesis 18:17; James 2:23*

God shared His plans with Abraham. Prayer can be bold when it's rooted in trust.

##### 2. Moses – Face-to-Face Communion

- *Exodus 33:11; 34:29; 2 Corinthians 3:7-11*

Time with God changes us. We reflect what we behold.

##### 3. David – Honest Heart Prayer

- *Psalms 9:1 (celebration), 13:1 (complaint), 22:1 (confusion), 51:4 (confession)*

God invites our whole hearts—joy, sorrow, questions, and repentance

##### 4. Mary of Bethany – Presence Over Performance

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- *Luke 10:42; John 12:3*

Mary sat, listened, and adored. Prayer starts with simply being with Jesus.

## **5. Jesus – Intimacy with the Father**

- *Mark 1:35; 14:36*

Jesus sought solitude and surrendered in prayer. He is our perfect example.

## **II. PRACTICAL TOOLS FOR PRIVATE PRAYER**

**1. Grow the Relationship:** The journey of beginning, developing, maturing

### **2. Watch for Growth Signs**

- More aware of God
- More honest and expressive
- More listening, less rushing
- Joy in just being with Him

### **3. Create Your Prayer Rhythm**

- Find a consistent space
- Start with just 10 minutes
- Pick a time that works—consistency beats length

### **4. Push Through Common Struggles**

- *Distractions?* Jot them down, refocus
- *Dryness?* Keep showing up
- *Lack of desire?* Be honest—tell God
- *Too busy?* Start small, stay steady

### **5. Use the PRAY Pattern**

- Pause – Be still and Present
- Rejoice – Give Thanks
- Ask – Bring your needs
- Yield – Surrender to God's will

**Reminder: Connect this Week with Virtual Prayer! →**

*Mornings (Mon-Fri): 7:30-8:15 am*

*Afternoons (Wed, Fri): 12:15-1:00 pm*

*Evenings (Mon, Tues, Thurs): 8:15-9:00 pm*

